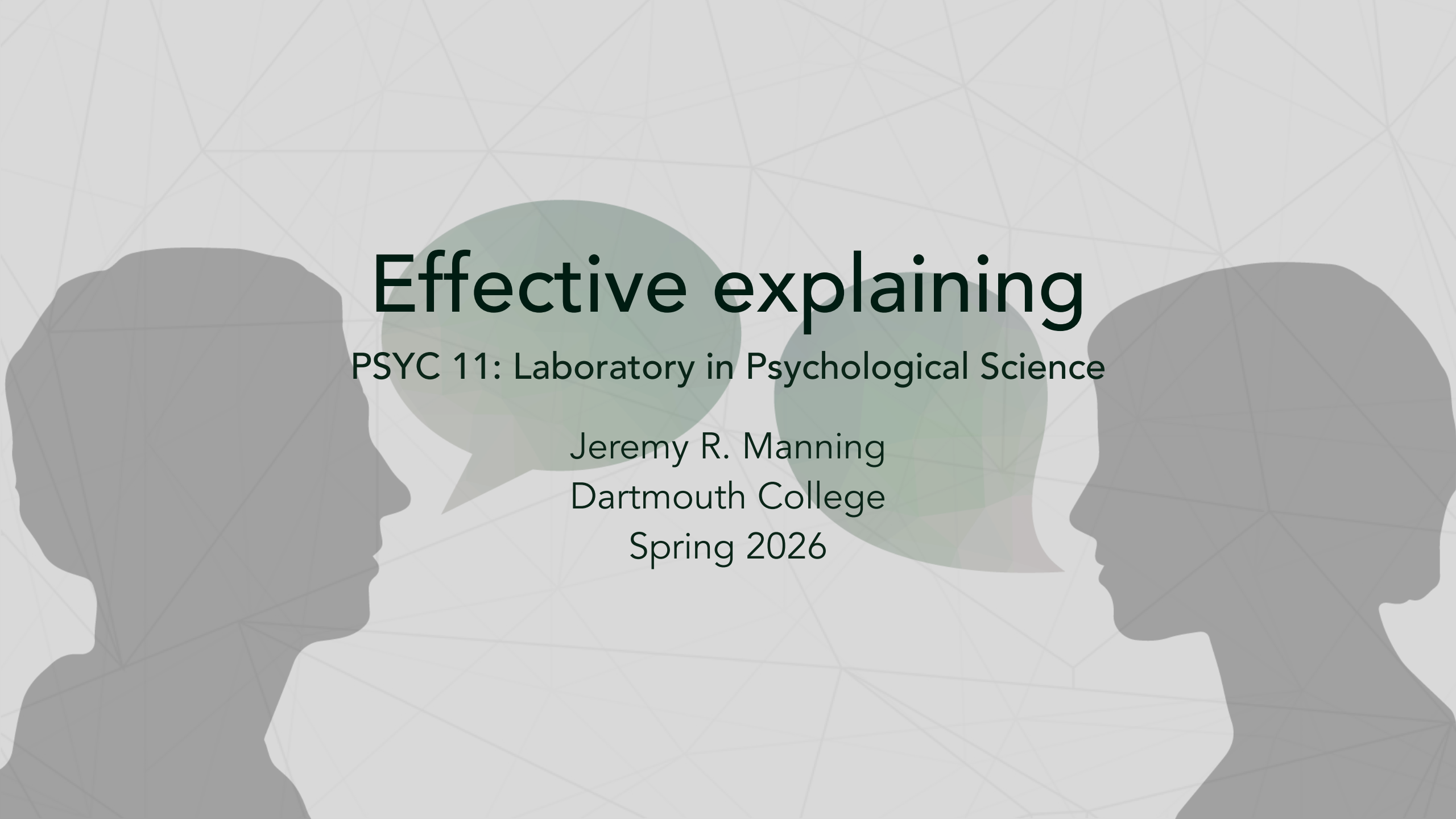




Effective explaining

PSYC 11: Laboratory in Psychological Science

Jeremy R. Manning
Dartmouth College
Spring 2026

Empathy: the core of (most) effective explanations

Know Your Audience

- Think about your intended audience
- What do they already know and what do they need to know?
- What sort of language will they respond to best?
- What tools (resources, data, etc.) does your audience need to carry out your instructions?
- How much time/space will you have to explain?

Necessary and sufficient details

Reproducibility

- Our (stated) goal in scientific research is often to enable others to **exactly** reproduce our study
- But what does "exact" really mean?
- Some aspects of your study will be critical to reproducing your procedure--- that's what you need to communicate
- Other details are unimportant--- you can leave those details out

Drawing lab

Goal

Understand and explore how to effectively communicate written procedural instructions (i.e., methods sections)

Drawing lab

Schedule

- **Today:** each group draws a picture and writes out instructions for reproducing it
- **Wednesday:** follow each others' instructions and evaluate performance
- **Friday:** analyze data

Drawing lab

